

Zeph Corvane

Character Dossier

Shy, brilliant and defensive lighthouse keeper of the Frostwall garrison on the northern border

Overview

Zeph Corvane is a lighthouse keeper living in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border. Zeph is 45 years old, originally from Wickham Hollow, and is known around the east rampart as shy, brilliant and defensive. In conversation Zeph ends sentences with 'you understand?'.

Background

Zeph arrived in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border 11 years ago after leaving Wickham Hollow under circumstances Zeph describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Frostwall Legion; the second was the one that stuck. Today Zeph works as a lighthouse keeper near the quartermaster's stores and is paid, when paid at all, in iron pennies.

Zeph learned the trade from Ysolde Fairweather, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Zeph's life is with Tomasz Nightingale, over a matter neither will explain. The person Zeph trusts most is Vesna Nightingale.

Current goal: to build a boat with no nails in it. Greatest fear: open water.

Personality and speech

Temperament: shy, brilliant and defensive.

Speech pattern: Zeph ends sentences with 'you understand?'.

Tells: when lying, Zeph mentions Halo the owl for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Zeph Corvane
Role	lighthouse keeper
Home	the Frostwall garrison on the northern border
Hometown	Wickham Hollow
Age	45
Favourite dish	the tavern's coconut porridge
Pet	Halo, a owl
Lucky number	291

<i>Workshop password</i>	drift-sparrow
<i>Mentor</i>	Ysolde Fairweather
<i>Rival</i>	Tomasz Nightingale
<i>Closest friend</i>	Vesna Nightingale

Secret

Zeph once forged a letter of passage for a stranger who turned out to be a wanted person, and still keeps the copy.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Zeph: I am the lighthouse keeper. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Zeph: The tavern's coconut porridge. Do not tell Tomasz I said so.

Visitor: Is Halo yours?

Zeph: Halo belongs to nobody. Halo tolerates me. Lucky number is 291, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 32

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the harvest count. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the old tunnels reached the east rampart. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Zeph repaired the cracked compass at the east rampart for Halcyon, who paid in 61 iron pennies and a long story about the tax on doors. Ysolde visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 2, autumn of year 32

Zeph found a coil of rope half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Zeph suspects Vesna and is probably right. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 3, spring of year 32

At the quartermaster's stores, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone. At the quartermaster's stores, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Zeph won 71 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. Fitzgerald came by asking about the singing at the docks. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 4, summer of year 32

Zeph won 5 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Zeph repaired the ledger at the signal tower for Hollis, who paid in 35 iron pennies and a long story about the comet. Wren came by asking about the quarantine. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zeph found a ledger half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 5, summer of year 33

At the east rampart, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real signal flag from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph repaired the bolt of linen at the east rampart for Farida, who paid in 37 iron pennies and a long story about the comet. Zeph won 53 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. Zeph closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Rumours about the quarantine reached the east rampart. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 6, winter of year 33

Olwen came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zeph repaired the bolt of linen at the mess hall for Percival, who paid in 9 iron pennies and a long story about the census. Zeph won 59 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. A dispute over the census flared up between Zeph and Tomasz outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the mess hall, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 7, autumn of year 33

Zeph closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Zeph was hired to carry a spool of wire from the east rampart to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Fenwick came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the tax on doors. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 8, summer of year 33

Zeph repaired the ledger at the east rampart for Ursula, who paid in 17 iron pennies and a long story about the harvest count. Zeph found a signal flag half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Ysolde visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before. Zeph was hired to carry a sack of salt from the east rampart to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Ysolde visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 9, spring of year 34

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 20 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. Zeph repaired the cracked compass at the mess hall for Lucienne, who paid in 88 iron pennies and a long story about who really won the regatta. The weather turned. Zeph moved the sextant indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Ysolde about the singing at the docks. Rumours about the tax on doors reached the mess hall. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Zeph was hired to carry a coil of rope from the mess hall to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 10, summer of year 34

Zeph won 48 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. Zeph repaired the clockwork bird at the signal tower for Gideon, who paid in 11 iron pennies and a long story about the comet. Zeph closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance.

Entry 11, winter of year 34

Matthias came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zeph closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. At the quartermaster's stores, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real pair of spectacles from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 33 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short.

Entry 12, winter of year 34

Zeph won 3 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the east rampart. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the census flared up between Zeph and Tomasz outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph found a spool of wire half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 13, winter of year 35

A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Zeph and Tomasz outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 87 of everything, except the spool of wire, which is always short. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 39 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Zeph won 37 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached the mess hall. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 14, summer of year 35

Seraphine came by asking about who really won the regatta. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zeph repaired the bundle of letters at the mess hall for Greta, who paid in 87 iron pennies and a long story about the harvest count. Zeph closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance.

Entry 15, summer of year 35

Zeph found a tin whistle half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zeph found a iron kettle half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. At the quartermaster's stores, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real wax seal from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about the tax on doors reached the quartermaster's stores. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 16, winter of year 35

Zeph closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Zeph was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the mess hall to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the new curfew flared up between Zeph and Tomasz outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Zeph moved the oilskin map indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Ysolde about who really won the regatta. Zeph closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance.

Entry 17, autumn of year 35

Zeph found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. At the quartermaster's stores, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. At the quartermaster's stores, Zeph taught Vesna how to

tell a real cracked compass from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph repaired the sextant at the quartermaster's stores for Olwen, who paid in 66 iron pennies and a long story about the quarantine.

Entry 18, spring of year 35

The weather turned. Zeph moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Ysolde about the singing at the docks. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the missing shipment. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 19, summer of year 35

Zeph was hired to carry a coil of rope from the signal tower to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Zeph suspects Vesna and is probably right. Zeph won 12 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. Zeph found a spool of wire half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. The weather turned. Zeph moved the copper pipe indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Ysolde about who really won the regatta.

Entry 20, winter of year 35

At the east rampart, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real bundle of letters from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the east rampart. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Zeph was hired to carry a sack of salt from the east rampart to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Zeph found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 21, autumn of year 36

A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Zeph closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the quartermaster's stores. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Zeph won 64 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge.

Entry 22, summer of year 36

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the new curfew. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Amadou came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. Bram came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zeph was hired to carry a sack of salt from the signal tower to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 23, summer of year 36

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the quartermaster's stores, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real wax seal from a fake one by weight alone. Freya came by asking about the singing at the docks. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 24, spring of year 36

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 81 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Zeph was hired to carry a spool of wire from the quartermaster's stores to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Zeph suspects Vesna and is probably right.

Entry 25, winter of year 36

Leocadia came by asking about the tariff on salt. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Zeph and Tomasz outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the quartermaster's stores, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. At the quartermaster's stores, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real iron kettle from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph repaired the iron kettle at the quartermaster's stores for Rhoswen, who paid in 47 iron pennies and a long story about the missing shipment.

Entry 26, summer of year 36

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 78 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short. Freya came by asking about the new curfew. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zeph closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 27 of everything, except the clockwork bird, which is always short.

Entry 27, winter of year 36

The weather turned. Zeph moved the copper pipe indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Ysolde about the right way to mend a net. Zeph found a coil of rope half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zeph found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 28, summer of year 36

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 38 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Brigid came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 29, autumn of year 36

Zeph repaired the spool of wire at the east rampart for Osric, who paid in 44 iron pennies and a long story about the singing at the docks. Zeph repaired the spool of wire at the east rampart for Torvald, who paid in 50 iron pennies and a long story about the old tunnels. Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Zeph suspects Vesna and is probably right. The weather turned. Zeph moved

the copper pipe indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Ysolde about the singing at the docks.

Entry 30, spring of year 36

A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Zeph and Tomasz outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Zeph moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Ysolde about whether the bridge will hold. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 63 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short.

Entry 31, winter of year 36

The weather turned. Zeph moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Ysolde about the price of lamp oil. Zeph was hired to carry a oilskin map from the mess hall to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Zeph repaired the grain scale at the mess hall for Jorah, who paid in 41 iron pennies and a long story about the harvest count.

Entry 32, summer of year 36

Zeph won 31 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. The weather turned. Zeph moved the cracked compass indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Ysolde about the tariff on salt. Ysolde visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 33, spring of year 36

Ysolde visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the quarantine. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the quartermaster's stores, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real hand bell from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance.

Entry 34, summer of year 36

Tallulah came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Zeph and Tomasz outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph was hired to carry a bolt of linen from the mess hall to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Zeph moved the cracked compass indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Ysolde about the tariff on salt.

Entry 35, autumn of year 36

Zeph was hired to carry a ledger from the mess hall to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Vesna came by asking about the tariff on salt. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. Ysolde visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Zeph and Tomasz outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 36, spring of year 36

Someone left a wax seal on the doorstep with no note. Zeph suspects Vesna and is probably right. Zeph won 71 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 45 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. Zeph repaired the ledger at the signal tower for Wendeline, who paid in 70 iron pennies and a long story about the rumour of a second well.

Entry 37, summer of year 36

Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Zeph suspects Vesna and is probably right. Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Zeph suspects Vesna and is probably right. At the signal tower, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. Ysolde visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 38, winter of year 36

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the quarantine. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rowan came by asking about the singing at the docks. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. Ysolde visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Zeph repaired the iron kettle at the frozen moat for Gustav, who paid in 61 iron pennies and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the frozen moat. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 39, spring of year 36

Zeph won 60 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Zeph and Tomasz outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 40, spring of year 36

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the census. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Zeph moved the grain scale indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Ysolde about whether the bridge will hold. Rumours about the harvest count reached the quartermaster's stores. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the quartermaster's stores, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 41, spring of year 36

Zeph found a sextant half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Zeph found a wax seal half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rumours about the census reached the mess hall. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Ysolde visited unannounced. They

argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 42, autumn of year 36

Zeph won 38 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 21 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. Zeph won 56 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Zeph and Tomasz outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance.

Entry 43, autumn of year 36

At the east rampart, Zeph taught Vesna how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph won 42 iron pennies from Tomasz on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on the tavern's coconut porridge. Zeph was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the east rampart to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 44, autumn of year 36

Ysolde visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Zeph closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Zeph found a signal flag half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 45, spring of year 37

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the east rampart: 81 of everything, except the pair of spectacles, which is always short. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the quarantine. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the east rampart: 86 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short.